▼ GLASSHOUSE



HISTORICAL BLUNDER

Telangana BJP leaders run for cover every time their national leaders bring up Andhra Pradesh's 2014 bifurcation in Parliament. The latest trigger was a comment by party MP **Tejasvi Surya**. Speaking during the special session on the 131st Constitution Amendment Bill, the Karnataka MP dismissed Telangana CM **Revanth Reddy's** proposed 'hybrid model' factoring GSDP into delimitation as "foolish". He also tore into the "Congress legacy of the Andhra Pradesh bifurcation", alleging it was worse than the India-Pakistan partition. Outraged Congress and Bharat Rashtra Samithi (BRS) leaders blasted the "ignorant" comments and demanded an immediate apology. It was left to state BJP chief Ramchander Rao to make amends, saying Surya's words had been "distorted" and that the Partition allusion was not a comparison of Telangana with Pakistan.

Illustrations by **SIDDHANT JUMDE**

▼ NAME GAMES

SHERU VS MAKKHI

If Rajasthan's firebrand education minister, **Madan Dilawar,** had his way, the first thing a newborn received could be a state-approved name. The idea: gently nudge parents away from those "embarrassing" names—think Shaitaan, Sheru, Tinku—when enrolling children in school. But then, the minister's list of 3,000 approved names doesn't entirely pass the silliness bar either:



Bhayankar (terrifying), Bhiksha (alms), Makkhi (fly), Bikaner (the city!), Dahi Bhai (yoghurt bro). So then, who gets to decide which name is absurd and which isn't? Not the folks who might nix 'Shaitan' without taking note of Major Shaitan Singh PVC, the 1962 war hero whose name screams valour, not villainy. Meanwhile, after a major outcry, Rajasthan has suspended the 'Sarthak' name initiative for now and clarified that it will always be for parents to decide whether or not to accept the state's suggestions.